EMPLOYEE MANUAL & JOB DESCRIPTIONS

GARDEN CITY CHURCH BEVERLY

VERSION 1.2

INTRODUCTION

Welcome aboard! We're thrilled to have you join our team and contribute to our mission of Garden City Church. As an employee of our church, it's important for you to know that we operate as a non-profit organization, which means we adhere to certain legal standards and obligations. As such, you have rights protected under state and federal labor laws, including but not limited to minimum wage requirements, anti-discrimination laws, and workplace safety regulations. We are committed to providing a safe and respectful work environment where you can thrive in your role. If you have any questions or concerns about your rights or responsibilities as an employee, please don't hesitate to reach out to our HR department or leadership team. Once again, welcome aboard, and we look forward to working together to make a positive impact in our community!

ABOUT

Serving within a church is more than just employment; it's an opportunity to engage in kingdom-work. We believe that our work yields eternal results, and it's a joy and privilege to know that through our labor, we are essentially working for the Lord. While this principle applies to all aspects of life, we find particular joy in directly contributing to the growth and expansion of the Church of Jesus Christ.

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OVERVIEW

At Garden City Church, all employees share common ministry goals, expectations, and standards. We are all working in the same direction with the same common hope.

PURPOSE

1. Provide clear and comprehensive guidance on employee roles, responsibilities, and expectations.
2. Promote focus and unity among leadership, fostering alignment that extends to the congregation.
3. Articulate the church's mission by ensuring alignment and guidance, empowering better service to the church community.

EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES

At Garden City Church, our employees play a pivotal role in advancing the mission and vision of the church. Each team member is entrusted with the responsibility to contribute their unique skills and faithfully carry out their part, ensuring the church fulfills its purpose. Together, through collaboration, open communication, and shared commitment, we support one another in achieving the mission God has called us to accomplish.

Employees are expected to offer visionary leadership within their assigned ministries, developing programs that encourage discipleship, or leading small group studies focused on biblical literacy. Our aim is to foster salvation, a deeper commitment to prayer and to the Scriptures, and the baptism of the Holy Spirit within our congregation. We actively mobilize efforts for outreach, evangelism, and mission trips. We seek creative, dynamic individuals eager to contribute their distinct gifts to our church family. Mutual support and a willingness to lend a hand across departments are highly valued. Here, the mindset of "that's not my job" is actively rejected in favor of a culture where we champion each other's success.

POSITION RELATIONSHIP

To ensure clear communication and minimize confusion, Garden City Church maintains an open-door policy, giving all employees direct access to their supervisors and ultimately the Lead Pastor. The Lead Pastor provides leadership for all staff, offering consultation, check-ins, development, encouragement, and counsel as needed. While collaboration across ministries is highly encouraged, it is important to clarify reporting relationships to avoid unnecessary confusion. All staff report directly to the Lead Pastor regarding their roles, responsibilities, and initiatives. Certain ministries, such as Children's and Youth, may require more frequent collaboration due to shared responsibilities or overlapping demographics. In such cases, open communication and teamwork are not only encouraged but expected.

To ensure clear communication and minimize confusion, Garden City Church upholds an open-door policy. This allows all employees direct access to their supervisors and ultimately the Lead Pastor. The Lead Pastor provides leadership for all pastors and remains available for consultation, check-ins, development, encouragement, and counsel with all employees.

Collaboration is highly encouraged, but to minimize unnecessary input, clarifying tiers of reporting is necessary. All staff report directly to the Lead Pastor, and collaboration across ministries is highly encouraged. Certain ministries, such as Children's and Youth Pastors, may need to work together more frequently due to shared responsibilities or overlapping demographics. In these cases, direct communication and collaboration is not only permitted but expected.

QUALIFICATIONS

1. Born-again believer, having received or actively pursuing the baptism of the Holy Spirit:
This foundational aspect of faith demonstrates a commitment to spiritual growth and empowerment.

2. Biblical worldview:
A firm adherence to biblical principles and values guides decision-making and actions in all aspects of life. (*see. the 16 Fundamentals of the AG, https://ag.org/beliefs/statement-of-fundamental-truths*)

3. Actively growing in faith:
Continual spiritual development and a deepening relationship with God are essential for personal and professional enrichment.

4. Garden City Church as a church home:
A deep connection and commitment to the church community fosters a sense of belonging and alignment with its mission and values.

5. Consistent tithing and support for missions:
Financial stewardship reflects a heart of generosity and investment in the advancement of God's kingdom.

6. Leadership and Practical Skill Sets:
Demonstrated leadership abilities, including teaching, public speaking, organization, and practical skills such as proficiency with basic computer and technology tools, are essential for effective ministry and service.

7. Familiarity with pop culture:
Understanding contemporary culture, especially concerning Young Adult, Youth, and Children's interests, facilitates meaningful engagement and communication within the ministry context.

8. Active participation in church prayer:
Regular involvement in corporate prayer underscores the importance of seeking God's guidance and empowerment in all endeavors.

9. Ministerial License and Bachelor's Degree (B.A. or B.S.) from an Accredited Institution:
Unless otherwise stated, a bachelor's degree from an accredited university is required, as it reflects the level of academic achievement and competency appropriate for the role. Additionally, candidates must either hold a ministerial license or be actively in the process of obtaining one.

10. Theology
Demonstrate commitment and understanding to Pentecostal Theology

EXPECTATIONS

- **Maintain Spiritual Life**
  - Regularly attend Garden City Worship Services, prayer meetings, and staff meetings.
  - Maintain a consistent private devotional life for effective ministry.
- **Continued Self-Development**
  - Attend leadership meetings, seminars, and conferences relevant to ministry (expenses covered with Lead Pastor's approval).
  - Read at least one leadership-related book per year.
  - Strive for spiritual growth and ministry effectiveness.
- **Pastoral Leadership and Ministry Representation**
  - Demonstrate and express the lead pastor's vision within relevant ministries.
  - Strive for continuity and alignment with the church's vision: "Live the life. Tell the story."
- **Relational Ministry**
  - Develop and maintain a relational, loving culture.
  - Recognize and utilize individuals' gifts and callings in ministry.
  - Be hospitable, courteous, flexible with a variety of personalities, and considerate.
  - Maintain healthy relationships with church members and team members.
- **Additional Expectations**
  - Attend and actively participate in mission trips and network events as required.
  - Bring solutions, not just problems, to foster a proactive and constructive environment (Philippians 2:14-15).
  - Be humble and encourage others (1 Peter 5:5-6; Ephesians 4:29).

ASSIGNED READING AND PRESENTATION

All new hires are required to read the following books in their first year—one book per quarter—and present a 15-minute teaching to the leadership team regarding their takeaways:

- **Deeper Experiences of Famous Christians** - James Gilchrist Lawson
- **Spirit and Truth: Reclaiming the Heart of Worship** - Aaron Rios
- **Visioneering: Your Guide for Discovering and Maintaining Personal Vision** - Andy Stanley
- **The Way of the Shepherd: Seven Secrets to Managing Productive People** - Kevin Leman, William Pentak
- **Strengthening the Soul of Your Leadership: Seeking God in the Crucible of Ministry** - Ruth Haley Barton

STAFF RESPONSIBILITIES

Pastoral Care
All staff will be assigned a caseload of parishioners and will be expected to follow up weekly with each individual on their list in a timely and reasonable manner. Maintain contact through visitation, hospitality, phone calls, cards, and emails to meet the congregation's needs.

“THE THREE C’S”

To enhance connection and flow within our community, the following is expected:

- **Communication**
  - Regularly report ministry progress to the Lead Pastor.
  - Communicate as necessary with *parents, ministry teams, and church members. *youth and children pastor
  - Coordinate ministry schedules with the church office in advance.
- **Cooperation**
  - Be a team player and remain flexible.
  - Focus on advancing the Kingdom of God collectively.
  - Fulfill ministry responsibilities including setup/teardown, equipment scheduling, and financial management.
- **Commitment**
  - Work designated hours per week, including Sundays.
  - Demonstrate loyalty and transparency in ministry.
  - Attend church functions.
  - Go beyond duty to advance God's work voluntarily.
  - Strive for excellence and passion in ministry.
  - Schedule a one-on-one meeting with the Lead Pastor if unable to maintain full commitment.

OUR DISCIPLESHIP PROCESS

All new employees are expected to assist in encouraging all congregants towards their 'next step' both in church process and personal growth. All employees must participate in each aspect and gain a basic understanding of each aspect of our processes and flow. We want a team that is 'all in.'

WORSHIP

Worship forms the core of our regular gatherings. Whether you join us for a weekend service or a Tuesday prayer night, the initial stage of our process is centered on worship. During our weekend gatherings, we participate in worship, partake in monthly communion, and engage in Bible teaching. We organize special Worship Nights throughout the year aimed at involving our community and extending a warm invitation to visit our church.

NEXT STEPS

Following your attendance at our weekend services, you might find yourself curious about our church. On the last Monday of each month, we organize a dedicated class tailored for newcomers called NEXT NIGHT. Our team will guide you through a campus tour, providing insights into the various ministry opportunities available. You will hear firsthand testimonies from our pastor and team members, gaining an understanding of our church's history and vision.

LEARN

We strongly encourage you to prioritize your personal growth in your relationship with God. To assist you on this journey, we have developed two courses tailored to help you become a disciple of Jesus:

FOLLOWING JESUS: A 7-week program designed to impart foundational Christian beliefs.

TRUTH-TREK: An ongoing annual program crafted to deepen your understanding of God's Word, equipping you to effectively disciple others and fulfill the Great Commission.

*Additional Classes to be announced and presented.

LOVE

We believe love is best demonstrated in community. We aim for you to connect with fellow Christ-followers and immerse yourself in community life through our **CORE GROUPS**. These groups advocate for transparent living, offering a safe space for individuals to openly share their challenged and achievements. CORE Groups gather at various times throughout the week, and some even offer childcare services.

LEAD

Leading in the church is synonymous with serving (Philippians 2:7). Engaging in service is fundamental to the life of every believer. Our ministries serve as places for you to participate and continue growing while partnering with others on their faith journeys. We also maintain active connections with missionaries and engage in local and global missionary work.

DOCTRINES OF MAJOR & MINORS

WHY DEFINE MAJORS & MINORS?

In today's church landscape, divisions arise over numerous issues. While some matters warrant careful consideration, others are principles we must firmly uphold, and yet others call for outright opposition. By clearly articulating our positions and stances on various matters, we can foster unity and provide clarity. Scripture advises against engaging in pointless quarrels over every minor issue (2 Timothy 2:14). While certain doctrines merit thoughtful reflection and discussion, others serve as distractions from the central mission of Christ.

MAJORS:

These are non-negotiable principles essential to the historical understanding of Christianity, such as the exclusive nature of salvation through Jesus Christ, the inerrancy of Scripture, and the triune nature of God.

MINORS:

These are perspectives we uphold but do not consider essential enough to sever fellowship over, such as theological debates like Calvinism vs. Arminianism and variations in baptismal practices.

THE MAJORS

**This list is not exhaustive, but it gives you an idea of what some majors are.*

THE SCRIPTURES ARE TRUSTWORTHY

The Bible stands as God's unique revelation to humanity. It is the inspired Word of God, serving as the authoritative and dependable guide for faith and practice (John 17:17; 2 Timothy 3:16-17; 1 Peter 1:24-25; Revelation 22:18-19).

ONE GOD, THREE PERSONS

God exists eternally as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, comprising one divine being (Matthew 28:18-20; Matthew 3:16-17).

JESUS, OUR SAVIOR AND KING

Jesus Christ, the Son of God, was born of the Virgin Mary. He lived a sinless life, willingly bore all humanity's sins, died, and bodily rose again. He now sits at the right hand of the Father and will return to fulfill God's eternal plan (John 3:16; Romans 5:8; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Matthew 21:1-11; Revelation 19:11-16).

SALVATION IS A GIFT

Humanity's need for salvation arises from sin, which cannot be overcome through personal goodness or human effort. Salvation is a gift received through humble repentance and faith in Christ's finished work on the cross (Romans 6:23; Ephesians 2:8-9).

MEMBERS OF THE BODY

All believers are integral parts of the Body of Christ, constituting the universal Church. Therefore, we do not practice local church membership (1 Corinthians 12:12-27). Faith without Works is Dead: While salvation is not earned through works, genuine faith naturally produces good works as evidence. Faith and works are intertwined, demonstrating the authenticity of salvation (James 2:14–17; Ephesians 2:10).

SPIRIT EMPOWERMENT

We believe in the tangible presence of God through the Holy Spirit, bringing radical transformation to those who receive Jesus into their lives and the demonstration of all spiritual gifts. (Matthew 28:20; John 1:12; John 16:13).

PRAYER

Prayer is indispensable for believers and vital for deepening Christian spirituality. Following the pattern set forth in 2 Chronicles 7:14, prayer serves as the primary means through which God connects and communicates with His people (2 Chronicles 7:14).

1 For further info on our fundamental beliefs, visit: https://ag.org/Beliefs/Statement-of-Fundamental-Truths

THE MINORS

**This list is not exhaustive, but it gives you an idea of what some minors are.*

ESCHATOLOGY:
There are various beliefs about how Christ will return, including pre-tribulation, mid-tribulation, and post-tribulation rapture. However, debating the specifics of Christ's return is akin to arguing about the exact color and physics of a staircase—it's not essential. What matters is that, like a staircase, Christ's return will fulfill its purpose if we faithfully do our part.

ETERNAL SECURITY VS. CONDITIONAL SECURITY
Some Christian circles teach that salvation can be lost, while others argue that it is eternally secure. Both views are considered serious errors according to passages like Galatians 3:1–3 and Hebrews 10:26. It's evident from the Bible that many claim to have secure salvation but lack a genuine relationship with Christ. Whether salvation was lost along life's journey or was never present, the crucial point is that if we faithfully follow Christ and demonstrate a genuine connection with God, our salvation remains secure.

CALVINISM VS. ARMINIANISM
Calvinism and Arminianism are theological systems that aim to explain the balance between God's sovereignty and human responsibility in salvation. While studying these systems can be enlightening, arguing over them is not productive. The Bible, rather than man-made theological theories, should be our primary reference point in understanding these matters.

5-FOLD MINISTRY
The 5-fold ministry, as outlined in Ephesians 4:11-13, encompasses distinct roles within the church: apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers. These roles serve essential functions in equipping and edifying the body of Christ. While there may be debates regarding the validity and continuation of these offices or the use of specific titles within certain circles, it's important to recognize that our focus should ultimately be on serving the Lord Jesus and fulfilling our individual roles within the church. We believe in the continuity of these gifts and the significance of these offices, but we also prioritize unity and cooperation rather than allowing disagreements over terminology or structure to become stumbling blocks in our collective mission.

"OTHER" DENOMINATIONS & MINISTERS' TEACHINGS

As believers, we adhere to the principle of refraining from criticizing other ministries, pastors, or leaders. While we acknowledge the importance of addressing corruption and mishandling of God's Word when necessary, we exercise caution in doing so. We recognize that our primary responsibility is to maintain integrity in our own actions and teachings, rather than engaging in unnecessary criticism of others. The Bible instructs us not to judge another man's servant (Romans 14:4), emphasizing the importance of humility and respect in our interactions with fellow believers and their ministries.

Therefore, if we find ourselves in disagreement with the methods or teachings of another ministry or denomination, our response is rooted in prayer rather than fostering contention, gossip, or criticism. We understand that we may not personally know the leaders or have a relationship with the communities being criticized, which further emphasizes the need for discernment and humility in our approach. Instead of focusing on differences, we prioritize unity within the body of Christ and extend grace to those with whom we may disagree. In essence, while we remain vigilant in upholding the truth and integrity of God's Word, we do so with a spirit of love, humility, and prayer, recognizing that our ultimate goal is to glorify God and build up His kingdom rather than tearing down others.

DOCTRINE REGARDING BAPTISM

Purpose of Baptism:
In essence, we baptize because Jesus instructed us to do so. In His final instructions to His disciples, Jesus commanded the baptism of all nations (Matthew 28:19). He not only gave this command but also led by example, being baptized Himself (Matthew 3:13–17). Despite having no need for repentance due to His sinless life, Jesus chose baptism as a demonstration of obedience to God the Father (Matthew 3:17). As followers of Christ, who strive to follow His example, we obey His command by undergoing baptism. Does Jesus require baptism? This question is misguided. Instead of focusing on the minimum requirement for salvation, we should recognize the gravity of sin and the magnitude of grace. Rather than asking what we must do for God, we should inquire about what we can do for Him.

Baptism:
We believe the Bible clearly teaches that baptism is an outward expression of an inward conviction - a decision rooted in obedience to Jesus. Baptism serves as a symbolic public declaration of our decision to follow Christ. Much like a wedding ring symbolizes marriage, baptism represents our commitment to Christ. However, just as a ring does not create a marriage, baptism alone does not secure our salvation. Unless preceded by genuine repentance (Matthew 3:8) and followed by a life of discipleship demonstrating true faith (James 2:17), baptism holds no significance.

Baptism by Immersion:
We believe in baptizing individuals who have repented of their sins and wish to publicly declare their faith in Jesus Christ through full-immersion baptism. However, we do not view baptism as possessing magical powers. No individual can grant or revoke salvation through the act of baptism (Romans 8:38–39).

If you have undergone a previous baptism that did not meet the aforementioned criteria, such as sprinkling or infant baptism without full comprehension, you may consider undergoing re-baptism. Nonetheless, genuine baptism need only occur once. If seeking forgiveness for sins committed post-baptism, sincere repentance and seeking forgiveness from God suffices.

DOCTRINE REGARDING COMMUNION

Communion:
Communion is a symbolic practice, serving as a reminder of Christ's death and sacrifice on the cross, resurrection and promised return. It utilizes bread to symbolize Jesus' body and the cup to symbolize His blood (Matthew 26, Mark 14, Luke 22, 1 Corinthians 11).

Purpose of Communion:
All followers of Jesus are welcome to participate in communion after self-examination. Paul's warning in 1 Corinthians 11:27 about taking communion "in an unworthy manner" underscores the importance of understanding its significance. Proper respect and reverence entails respectfully reflecting on the elements that represents Jesus' body and the purpose of remembering His death and sacrifice (1 Corinthians 11:29).

Communion at Garden City Church:
Communion is available the first Sunday of every month during Family Sundays. We invite families to receive communion with one another. During this time, we encourage all believers to reflect on their lives and seek forgiveness. Respect for the solemnity of the occasion is encouraged, recognizing its profound significance in human history.

CHURCH STRUCTURE:

1. SNEMN - Southern New England Ministry Network
Garden City Church operates within the Southern New England Ministry Network (SNEMN) as a cooperative fellowship of the Assemblies of God. The church functions under the district leadership of Superintendent Nick Fatato.

2. LEAD PASTOR
Aaron Rios serves as the Lead Pastor of Garden City Church. He provides the overarching mission and vision that guides every aspect of the organization.

3. BOARD
The Board of Garden City Church comprises District-Appointed officials responsible for overseeing finances and ensuring church operations align with the core tenets of the Assemblies of God Fellowship.

4. ASSOCIATES
Associate Pastors are leaders selected by the Lead Pastor to assist with co-pastoring duties, particularly concerning the spiritual health and vitality of the community.

THE ROLE OF WOMEN IN MINISTRY:

Garden City Church affirms the giftedness of both men and women for ministry. We believe in the biblical principle that ministry and leadership roles are appointed to individuals based on their callings and obedience to God, regardless of gender. This includes recognizing and supporting women in various ministry capacities within the church community.

DOCTRINE REGARDING SEXUALITY

We are officially a 'Welcoming-Non Affirming' community.

We believe that God created all men and women in His image, but sin leads humanity to rebel against God and His Word, including in the area of human sexuality. At Garden City Church, we welcome all who struggle with sin, including sexual sin, and guide them toward repentance and faith in Jesus Christ as Lord and Savior.

Marriage:
Marriage is a covenant relationship created by God, intended to be between one man and one woman until death separates them. Anything outside of this God- given institution is considered sin and not validated by God.

LGBTQ+:
To those grappling with promiscuity, same-sex attraction, or gender dysphoria, we direct them to the transforming power of God to lead us to holiness in conformity to His Son's image. While we embrace all who struggle with sin, we do not affirm anything contrary to God's Word. We believe Gods word teaches us that we can meet God exactly as we are, but his love will transform us.

If you are in a same-sex relationship or marriage, you and your family are wholeheartedly welcome. While we are a welcoming - non-affirming" church, we greet, love, and respect all individuals without exception. Our teaching is rooted in the entirety of the Bible, which includes upholding the sacred union of one man and one woman in marriage.

Concerning same-sex marriages, we believe in honoring the sacred covenant established by God, which requires compliance with His terms. Marriage, as defined by God, is a covenant between Him, one man, and one woman. We invite you to explore God's love and His desire for a personal relationship with you, regardless of your current circumstances. We would love to walk with you on your spiritual journey.

DOCTRINE REGARDING INTOXICATION

We believe in adhering strictly to the biblical injunction to be controlled by the Holy Spirit in both our thoughts and behaviors *(Romans 8:9, Romans 12:2).* While some theological positions may advocate for the permissibility of alcohol consumption, we recognize the pervasive societal struggle with alcoholism and addiction. In light of this, we maintain our stance against all forms of alcohol consumption primarily with our Pastoral Team, Staff and Board Members.

While acknowledging differing interpretations, we firmly believe that a life of sobriety is overwhelmingly advocated for in the Bible - especially for the betterment and example of those in our community who have come out of a life of addiction and abuse.

We believe that embracing sobriety aligns us more closely with the teachings of Jesus Christ and enables us to better fulfill our mission to serve and support one another in faith.

MUSIC AND SERVICE FLOW

we strive to create an environment aligned with the activities and approval of the Holy Spirit. Our music selection is contemporary and thoughtfully curated to create a worshipful-Holy Spirit enriched environment. Our primary goal is to ensure that everyone who enters feels welcomed and encounters the genuine presence and power of the Holy Spirit. We view music and service flow as integral to pointing towards the ministry of the Word and at all times keeping Jesus front and center. Sunday services are intentionally designed to be evangelistic in nature, ensuring that first-time guests feel included and valued. We recognize that not everyone attending a service may already be saved, and we aim to reach out to all individuals, regardless of their background or experiences. We are mindful that attendees may come from diverse situations, including those who might be experiencing desperation, such as spending the weekend on a drug binge or encountering a traumatic situation. Our commitment is to honor and welcome all individuals equally, showing them the same respect and compassion.

EMPLOYEE REQUIREMENTS

1. COMMITMENT TO CORE DOCTRINES AND VALUES:

All employees must wholeheartedly adhere to the church's core doctrines, including the AG 16 Fundamentals. Personal beliefs and preferences that conflict with these doctrines should be set aside in all church-related activities. Teach and lead in alignment with these core values, avoiding theological disputes on non-essential matters.

2. MANDATORY PARTICIPATION IN KEY CLASSES:

Attend and be prepared to lead key classes such as Following Jesus, Authentic Discipleship, and Holy Spirit. Continuous education in these areas ensures that all staff members are equipped to guide and mentor the congregation effectively. As 2 Timothy 2:15 (NIV) says,“Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth.”

3. ATTENDANCE AND VACATION POLICY:

General Attendance

As key leaders in our church community, it is essential for the Pastoral Team and Employees to be present at all regular church services, including Sunday services, midweek gatherings, and special events. Your presence not only sets a positive example for the congregation but also allows you to effectively minister to and connect with our members, particularly the youth and children under your care.

Holiday Services

Our church celebrates major holidays such as Christmas and Easter with special services and activities. These occasions are significant opportunities for outreach and community building. Therefore, all staff are expected to attend and actively participate in these holiday services.

Extended Services and Activities

From time to time, our church may hold extended services, revivals, retreats, or other special activities. As a member of our pastoral team, your attendance and involvement in these events are crucial. Your employment hours are designed to include participation in these services, recognizing the importance of your role in supporting and leading our congregation during these times.

Vacation Policy

General Vacation Time

We understand the importance of rest and personal time, and we encourage our pastoral staff to take vacation time to recharge and spend with their families. Vacation requests should be submitted in advance and will be approved on a first-come, first-served basis, considering church needs and staffing levels. Within the first month of each year, we will build calendars to accommodate potential vacations, anniversaries, and other important dates. Our goal is to anticipate and intentionally schedule these dates to ensure a healthy and balanced work schedule for everyone. We value you and your family, as well as your mental, emotional, and physical well-being. Because of this, we encourage you to honor your work schedule—both in the times you are supposed to be at work and the times you are supposed to have off. Health requires balance, and we are committed to supporting you in achieving it. All employees are encouraged 4 Sundays off a year (1 per quarter) and are automatically given two weeks of paid vacation a year - not including sick leave. Additional time can be requested and work schedules can be flexible (we encourage conversations with the lead pastor).

Major Holidays

Due to the significant nature of major holidays such as Christmas and Easter, vacations are not permitted during these times. All staff are required to be present and actively serve during these critical periods. Exceptions may be made in extraordinary circumstances, but these must be approved by church leadership well in advance and are subject to the needs of the church.

Alternative Scheduling

In rare cases, the church may issue an alternative schedule that affects vacation availability. We will communicate any such changes as early as possible to allow you to plan accordingly. Your flexibility and understanding in these situations are greatly appreciated.

Understanding and Support

We value and appreciate the dedication and hard work you bring to our church community. By being present and engaged in all services and activities, especially during major holidays, you help to foster a welcoming and vibrant environment for all members and visitors. We are committed to supporting you in your ministry and ensuring you have the time you need for personal rest and rejuvenation.

If you have any questions or need further clarification regarding this policy, please feel free to reach out to church leadership. We are here to support you and ensure that your time with us is fulfilling and balanced.

4. UPHOLDING ETHICAL AND MORAL STANDARDS:

Standards, including those related to communion, baptism, sexuality, and sobriety. Address any deviations according to the church's disciplinary procedures. Ephesians 5:1-2 encourages us, "Follow God's example, therefore, as dearly loved children and walk in the way of love, just as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us as a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God."

5. SPIRITUAL GROWTH AND DEVELOPMENT:

Pursue your own spiritual growth through regular personal devotions, prayer, and participation in church services and activities. Personal commitment to spiritual development is crucial for effective ministry and leadership. Philippians 3:14 urges us, "I press on toward the goal to win the prize for which God has called me heavenward in Christ Jesus."

6. TEAMWORK AND UNITY:

Foster a spirit of unity and collaboration by attending staff meetings, participating in team-building activities, and supporting one another in ministry efforts. As John Maxwell says, "Teamwork makes the dream work."

7. PASSION AND ENTHUSIASM:

Exhibit passion and enthusiasm in your role, inspiring others through your dedication and positive attitude. Seek ways to advance the church's mission and engage with the congregation energetically. Colossians 3:23 reminds us, "Whatever you do, work at it with all your heart, as working for the Lord, not for human masters."

8. CONDUCT:
Maintain a high standard of professional and personal conduct, including appropriate dress, punctuality, respect for others, and adherence to the church's code of conduct both within and outside of church activities. Proverbs 22:1 states, "A good name is more desirable than great riches; to be esteemed is better than silver or gold."

9. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT AND TRAINING:
Engage in ongoing professional development through training and development programs, including leadership training, pastoral care, and other relevant courses. Timothy Keller reminds us, "Growth in character is just as important as growth in ministry skills."

10. DYNAMIC AND ADAPTABLE LEADERSHIP:
Demonstrate dynamic leadership qualities, being adaptable and responsive to the changing needs of the church and congregation. Be open to new ideas, embrace innovation, and effectively manage change within the church. Isaiah 43:19 (NIV) says, "See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it? I am making a way in the wilderness and streams in the wasteland."

11. FUN AND POSITIVE ENVIRONMENT:
Create a positive and enjoyable work environment, fostering a sense of fun and joy in ministry, building a vibrant community where people feel welcomed and valued. Proverbs 17:22 (NIV) reminds us, "A cheerful heart is good medicine, but a crushed spirit dries up the bones."

12. HOSPITALITY:
Be hospitable, creating a welcoming atmosphere for all. Hebrews 13:2 (NIV) instructs, "Do not forget to show hospitality to strangers, for by so doing some people have shown hospitality to angels without knowing it."

13. PROBLEM-SOLVING ATTITUDE
Don't just bring problems; bring solutions. Philippians 2:14-15 (NIV) encourages, "Do everything without grumbling or arguing, so that you may become blameless and pure, 'children of God without fault in a warped and crooked generation.' Then you will shine among them like stars in the sky."

14. PARTICIPATION IN MISSION TRIPS AND NETWORKING EVENTS:
Be willing and able to attend mission trips and networking events, contributing to the global and local outreach of the church. Acts 1:8 (NIV) reminds us, "But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth."

15.HUMILITY AND ENCOURAGEMENT:
Display humility and encourage others, reflecting the servant leadership of Jesus. Philippians 2:3 (NIV) says, "Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit. Rather, in humility value others above yourselves." John Maxwell also notes, "People don't care how much you know, until they know how much you care."

16.GIVING AND FASTING:
All employees are expected to tithe and fast in accordance with our church's teachings. Our church believes that tithing is a biblical expectation, just as fasting and prayer are (Matthew 6:5-18). This aligns with our CORE Values of generosity and extends into the realm of faithfulness and demonstration.

For credentialed or ordained employees whose giving is directed towards a district, we encourage them to maintain their commitment as required. We also encourage all employees to consider missional giving and to participate in other aspects of giving as they feel led by the Lord. We believe in sowing into our community and others, but first bringing it into the storehouse.

Additionally, we encourage all employees to fast regularly and to participate in our annual fast or other church-wide initiatives. Fasting can take various forms, including specialized meal plans or modifications that suit individual needs. The most important aspect is a willing heart. While we do not mandate participation, we seek employees who understand the value of commitment and participation.

COMING SOON

STAFF JOB DESCRIPTIONS

Stay Tuned!



Garden City Church
www.gardencitychurch.net
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